

Control Plan Reaction Plans - Complete Guide

What To Do When Controls Fail | Quality Head Agents

Why Reaction Plans Fail Audits

The most common Control Plan audit finding is a vague reaction plan. Phrases like "inspect further", "rework if possible", or "inform supervisor" are NOT acceptable. A good reaction plan must specify: WHO does WHAT, WHEN, and HOW to prevent non-conforming product reaching the customer.

Elements of a Good Reaction Plan

1. Segregate: Identify and physically segregate all suspect product (define scope - e.g., since last good piece). 2. Contain: 100% sort or inspection of segregated material. 3. Notify: Specify who must be informed (QA Manager, customer if applicable). 4. Correct: Describe the process correction needed. 5. Record: Specify which form or system to use. 6. Escalate: Define escalation if no fix in defined timeframe.

Reaction Plan by Characteristic Type

CC Characteristic out of spec: (1) Stop production immediately. (2) Segregate all product since last conforming piece. (3) 100% sort using calibrated gauge. (4) Notify QA Manager and Plant Head within 30 minutes. (5) Raise NCR. (6) Initiate 8D within 24 hours if repeat occurrence. SC Characteristic out of spec: (1) Stop and check last 10 pieces. (2) Segregate suspect batch. (3) 100% inspect suspect material. (4) Notify QA Engineer. (5) Record in rejection log.

SPC Out of Control Reaction

When an SPC chart signals out of control (any of the 8 Nelson rules): (1) Operator marks chart with note. (2) Inform QA/Supervisor. (3) Check last good part - is it within spec? (4) Find and fix the special cause. (5) Take 5 consecutive measurements to confirm process is back in control. (6) Do not tamper with the process without understanding the cause.

IATF Requirement

IATF 16949 Clause 8.5.1.1 requires that reaction plans are specified for all monitoring methods on the Control Plan. During audits, the auditor may ask the operator to demonstrate what they would do if a specific characteristic went out of spec. The operator must be trained on the reaction plan.